

etc. Once you develop a product line, after 4 or 5 years of existing, your older products have reached their end-of-life, as far as you're concerned. You certainly do not want products from 2016 being sold by anyone, refurbished or not. While you cannot stop individuals from exercising their right to buy and sell from each other, you certainly can, say, sue a company for deciding to buy up a lot of old stock, refurbish them, and then resell them. Not only does this ruin your brand image, it also cuts out your profits from sales of your cheaper devices.

Imagine a company selling a refurbished 2017 Pineapple 10+ Ultra with a brand new battery for just cheaper than your budget model, the 2021 Pineapple 13 mini. Although 4 years old, the 10+ Ultra was top of the range (flagship) at the time, and also happens to have a bigger screen and better camera than your budget offering of the 13 mini. While most people these days would be enticed by the new phone, your company, Pineapple, might lose out on at least a couple of million dollars in sales to those who realise that the 10+ Ultra is just a better deal... Add to that there's this pesky honest media house

called Digit, that will tell people the truth about it being a better deal, and the loss in sales is only going to rise.

Now, is it bad to be selling older hardware in 2021? Does that damage the brand image of Pineapple? A brand would certainly believe so, because of the loss in terms of sales of newer devices, but when you consider the environment or just value for money, maybe it isn't such a bad thing? We'll let you decide that...

INNOVATION

A huge pushback to the right to repair movement is that brands feel it stifles innovation, as them having to essentially provide complete documentation to all third party repair shops would allow competitors to study their products and the way they are implemented in great detail, which in turn would limit their innovation, or allow competitors to mimic their products with just small enough differences to not violate patents.

This one is a little harder to swallow, because we seriously doubt that any electronics engineer working at the level of a designer in, say, Apple, cannot take apart the latest Samsung phone

and immediately see how it was built, and what innovations were being made in terms of hardware. If anything, it's the software layer where a lot of the innovation is happening, which is perhaps also just as easy to "copy" or rather, "be inspired by". If there's industrial espionage happening between competing companies, it's happening at the level of R&D itself, and certainly not on finished products.

In all honesty, this pushback of brands is the weakest, because so many third party repair shops, run by individuals or very small groups, are already able to piece together what every little capacitor in a popular product does, how it is connected and what voltage and resistances, etc, they have / should have. And none of those things grant access to a phone's software / data.

Brands which are known to oppose the right to repair movement include Apple, Amazon, Microsoft, Google, Facebook, Tesla, Philips, John Deere, Caterpillar, eBay, AT&T, General Electric, and many more. But maybe it's time to address the elephant in the room and actually get down to what the right to repair movement wants? 

THE MOVEMENT

A LOOK AT THE RIGHT TO REPAIR MOVEMENT AND WHAT THEY WANT

Would you buy a car that forbade you from ever changing a tyre, and did so by voiding your warranty if you changed said tyre? Someone will probably accuse us of being flippant using tyres as an example... so let's say suspension. Would you buy a car that

voids warranty if you change your suspension after 1 year, even if it's to upgrade your suspension to a performance grade one? Sure, you could understand if they refused to cover anything related to the suspension, but completely washing their hands off all responsibility?

Now, assuming you were OK with voided warranty, how would you feel

about a car company that you take your car to, after a year of use, telling them that your suspension is damaged (not their fault, totally your fault, because you drove it over horrible terrain), and wanted the suspension replaced. Their response? Sure, replacing the suspension will cost half the cost of a car, so why don't you leave your car here, and take home a